Hope Hospital		
		Guidance on Medications return
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Reviewed On :- 16/01/2023 **Reviewed On :-** 15/01/2025	**Created by Quality Coordinator** Signature/Name: Dr. Darpan Jakkal,	**Guidance and Approved by Director** Signature/Name: Dr. B K Murali

1. Purpose

To provide a standard procedure for the return of medications from wards, departments, and patients, ensuring accountability, safety, and compliance with regulatory norms.

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2. Scope

Applies to all medications returned to the pharmacy, including from:

- Inpatient wards
- Outpatient areas
- Operating theatres
- Patients (in case of discharge, change in therapy, or expiry)

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3. Types of Medication Returns

Type	Examples
Unopened, Unused	Unused medicines in sealed, intact packaging
Opened but Unused	Syrups or creams with broken seal (usually not accepted)
Expired/Damaged	Expired drugs, deteriorated packaging, temperature excursions

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4. General Return Policy

A. From Inpatient Wards/Departments

- Medications must be:
  - In original packaging
  - Properly labeled with batch number and expiry date
  - Not expired or damaged
- Return should be documented in the **Drug Return Form** (Annexure attached if needed).
- Pharmacy staff to inspect condition before accepting.
- Returned drugs shall be:
  - Restocked if reusable (meets quality standards)
  - Disposed if damaged or expired (as per Biomedical Waste Rules)

B. From Patients (IPD/OPD)

- Accepted if:
  - Drug therapy was stopped or changed
  - The medication is unopened, unused, and within expiry
- Reusable drugs can be credited/refunded only if policy permits
- Partial strips, opened bottles, and reconstituted items **should not** be accepted for reuse

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5. Documentation

- All returns must be recorded with:
  - Date and time
  - Source department/patient details

    - Name, batch no., expiry, quantity
    - Reason for return
    - Action taken (restocked/disposed)
- Maintained in the **Medication Return Register**

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6. Storage of Returned Medications

- Temporarily store returned drugs in a designated **'Returned Drugs' shelf or bin** in the pharmacy
- Segregate those fit for reuse and those meant for disposal

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7. Disposal of Non-Reusable Medications

- Expired or damaged medications must be disposed:
    - As per **Biomedical Waste Management Rules, 2016**
    - In coordination with the hospital waste disposal vendor
- Maintain a **Drug Disposal Logbook** with pharmacist's signature